

The plates of bone on the back may have been used for display.

▼ SPIKED TAIL

Carnivores that leaped on *Kentrosaurus* or that were lashed by its tail risked being stabbed by the tail spikes and suffering fatal injuries.

Long tail spike

ONE BRAIN OR TWO?

Scientists used to think that *Kentrosaurus* had two brains: a tiny one in its head and a larger one in its rear end. However, experts now think its “rear brain” was just an energy store and not a brain at all.



Kentrosaurus

KEN-troh-SORE-uss

- **When** 156–150 million years ago (Late Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** Tanzania
- **Habitat** Forests
- **Length** 16½ ft (5 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Seven pairs of plates ran along *Kentrosaurus*'s neck and back. It had a pair of long spikes on its shoulders to protect itself from side attacks and a series of spikes along its tail to fend off attacks from behind. An entire skull fossil has never been found, but *Kentrosaurus* probably had a narrow snout and tiny teeth like other stegosaurs.

